Epic Breakdown Canvas

Turn a big idea into an MVP, a handful of valuable features, and the first stories a team can start.

Break Down Work · Epic Hypothesis · Minimum Viable Product · Feature Slicing

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

EPIC: Reorder made easy

OWNER: Priya

1 Epic Hypothesis — WHY ARE WE DOING THIS?

For...	busy households who shop weekly	(the customers or users)
who...	spend 40 minutes rebuilding the same basket	(have this need or problem)
the...	Reorder made easy epic	(epic name)
is a...	set of reorder features	(what it is: product, service, capability)
that...	lets them repeat their shop in one tap	(provides this value)
unlike...	searching for each item again	(the current solution or competitor)
our solution...	remembers the basket and fills the gaps	(does this better)

2 Outcomes & Measures

Business outcomes: how we'll know it worked

- Repeat orders 22% → 30%
- Median basket time under 10 min

Leading indicators: early signals

- Reorder clicks per visit
- Baskets started from a reorder

3 Minimum Viable Product — TEST IT SMALL

Smallest thing that tests the hypothesis:

Last-order card with one-tap reorder, in-stock items only, for 10% of returning customers

Persevere if... 25% use it within 4 weeks

Pivot or stop if... fewer than 10% use it

4 Features — SPLIT THE EPIC INTO 3-8 FEATURES THAT EACH DELIVER VALUE

FEATURE 1

Name: Last-order card

Benefit: see the last basket at a glance

Size: ☐ S ☑ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☑ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 2

Name: One-tap reorder

Benefit: fill the basket in one tap

Size: ☐ S ☑ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☑ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 3

Name: Substitutes

Benefit: no gaps when items are out

Size: ☐ S ☐ M ☑ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 4

Name: Order history

Benefit: reorder any past shop

Size: ☑ S ☐ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

FEATURE 5

Name: Usual-item reminders

Benefit: fewer forgotten items

Size: ☐ S ☑ M ☐ L ☐ XL

☐ Part of the MVP

5 First Stories — FROM THE MVP FEATURES

- Slice vertically: each story is usable end-to-end
- Too big for an iteration? Use the Story Splitting poster

- Show the last order on the home page
- Reorder adds every in-stock item
- Flag unavailable items
- Track reorder clicks
- Hide the card for first-time customers

6 Out of Scope & NFRs

We are explicitly not doing:

- Subscriptions
- Personalised offers
- Native app changes

Non-functional needs (security, scale...):

- Loads in under 1 second on mobile
- WCAG AA; works with a screen reader

7 Dependencies & Risks

- Other teams, systems or suppliers we need
- What could stop or delay this?

- Stock API from Warehouse (for substitutes)
- Analytics events need privacy sign-off
- Nothing needed from Payments for the MVP

"What's the smallest thing we could build to learn whether this epic is worth it?"

"Which feature, if it were the only one, would still deliver value?"

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